

4. Playing YouTube videos is easy but stopping them is irritatingly difficult. Strangely, the tablet wouldn't open any of the movie files on a USB drive – even common formats such as .avi and .flv.



Aakash 2

Notion Ink Adam

Hardware

Adam's actually a pretty handsome tablet, and it sports a unique design, whereas most every recent slate is a variation on the original iPad formula, Notion Ink endowed its offspring with a sizable rump that serves a variety of functions. It holds a pair of stereo speakers, one at either end, with the unit's three-cell battery sandwiched in between; it serves as an axis around which the swivelling camera rotates; and it makes for a fantastic grip. The 3.2 megapixel camera attached to the Adam has one neat trick – it swivels to swap between front- and rear-facing orientations and it automatically flips the image when it detects which way is up.

The upper left-hand corner of the bezel is where you'll find the Adam's four capacitive touch buttons. They're not backlit, provide no vibrating feedback, and are in a position where it's easy to brush them with stray gestures. There's a lot of fuss about connecting tablets to keyboards and televisions as of late, but the Adam doesn't need a proprietary keyboard, cables or docks because it's got two full-sized USB ports and a full-sized HDMI slot. Adam can do a full 1080p display mirroring over the HDMI port.

Display / touchscreen

Adam might be the first mass-market device to ship with a Pixel Qi screen, and a matte one at that. The Pixel Qi's reflective mode most certainly does work, and it does its job well, saving hours of additional battery life and making the screen quite viewable outdoors.

Software

Technically, the Adam runs a build of Android 2.2 but you'd be hard-